

# Kai Fukazawa

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## EDUCATION

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### University of California, Davis

September 2021 - Present

Ph.D. in Mechanical Engineering, GPA: (3.8/4.0)

*Research Focus:* Reinforcement Learning, Imitation Learning, Generative Models, Robotics

Supervised by Dr. Iman Soltani

### Kogakuin University

B.E. in Mechanical Engineering

April 2016 - March 2020

### Harvey Mudd College

Engineering Exchange Program

Jan 2019 - May 2019

## EXPERIENCE

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### OIST

Research Internship

January 2021 - September 2021

[Project Report](#)

## PUBLICATIONS

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### RAMAC: Multimodal Risk-Aware Offline Reinforcement Learning and the Role of Behavior Regularization

*ICML 2026*

K. Fukazawa, K. Mundada, I. Soltani

[Project Page](#) | [Paper](#) | [Code](#)

### Gaze on the Prize: Shaping Visual Attention with Return-Guided Contrastive Learning

A. Lee, I. Chuang, D. Gao, K. Fukazawa, I. Soltani

*Under Review at ICRA 2027*

[Project Page](#) | [Paper](#)

## WORKING PROJECTS

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### Reliable Self-Improvement for Long-Horizon Robot Learning

K. Fukazawa, Devi I. Soltani

*September 2026 – Present*

Developing scalable methods for long-horizon robot self-improvement from accumulated failure and recovery experience, studying compounding errors and distribution shift with modern vision-language-action policies.

### Mitigating Compounding Errors in Imitation Learning

K. Fukazawa, I. Soltani

*February 2026 – Present*

We are developing an approach to reduce compounding errors in imitation learning without complicating the learning pipeline. Our preliminary experiments show consistent improvements of **10-15%** over standard imitation learning baselines, including diffusion policies.

## TEACHING

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### Teaching Assistant

Jan 2022 – Present

*University of California, Davis*

Courses: Numerical Analysis, Control Systems & Theory, Dynamics, Vehicle & Transportation Systems

## SKILLS

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**Programming:** Python, C/C++, MATLAB, R, Java

**Machine Learning:** PyTorch, TensorFlow, JAX, Gym

**Others:** MuJoCo, PyBullet, Linux, Git, CUDA, ROS, Docker, OpenCV, Raspberry Pi

**Language:** English (Fluent), Japanese (Naitve)